MAGI

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT · VERSION 0.1 · WORKING DRAFT

1. Product vision

Magi is a minimalist effects tool library that lets users experiment with creative visual effects live or with uploaded media, then save their results to their device.

2. Product concept

Magi is a creative tool, not a social network. Users browse a library of visual effects, apply one to a live camera feed or uploaded photo/video, adjust its parameters, and capture or save the result. The product should make visual experimentation accessible without requiring complicated editing software.

3. Platform and audience

- **Platform:** Web application, desktop-first, with responsive support for mobile browsers.
- **Inputs:** Live camera, uploaded photos, and uploaded videos.
- **Audience:** Artists, independent creators, and people who enjoy experimenting with camera effects and visual aesthetics.

4. Release scope

First release: Bitmap. Planned future effects: ASI Symbols, Binary, and X's and O's. These are not required for the first release.

5. Bitmap effect

Bitmap converts visual input into a strictly black-and-white pixel composition. It uses square pixels; no gray values are rendered. The perceived gray tones emerge from the distribution and density of black and white pixels.

- Darker source areas produce denser black pixel coverage; lighter areas produce sparser coverage.
- The effect responds to generalized depth information when available; it does not require face or hand tracking.
- Motion should be gentle and restrained by default.
- Must work with both live camera input and uploaded photos/videos.

Controls

- **Scale:** Adjusts pixel size. Default: medium.
- **Intensity:** Adjusts the strength of the effect.
- Both controls have sensible limits; exact ranges are to be determined through prototyping.
- Provide a consistent reset-to-defaults control.

6. Core experience

A. Input and camera

- Open to a clean camera interface with live camera as the default input.

- Allow users to switch to uploaded photos or videos.
- Use the same effects workflow for live and uploaded media.

B. Select and adjust effects

- Open the effects tray using a minimal caret control positioned at the bottom-right.
- Show effects as text-only rectangular tiles; all tiles share identical dimensions.
- Do not use preview thumbnails in the initial design.
- Apply one effect at a time; no effect stacking in the initial release.
- Keep shared controls consistent across effects where practical, while allowing the system to evolve.

C. Capture and save

- **Photo:** Tap/click once to capture.
- **Video:** Tap/click once to start recording and again to stop; recording should not require holding the control.
- After capture, freeze the preview. Provide retake and save actions.
- Retake returns to the live camera. Save downloads the result to the device.
- Use a download-icon animation as the save feedback; avoid extra decorative confirmation.

7. Interface and visual direction

Design principle: The best interface is barely noticed. The interface should be quiet and functional so the visual effects remain the focus.

- Minimalist, Maison Margiela-inspired restraint; take inspiration from the philosophy, not the brand's logo or proprietary identity.
- Black-and-white interface shell.
- Neutral sans-serif typography; Inter is the initial recommendation, using regular/light weights and generous spacing.
- Main camera screen: small inverse-color M mark at top-left; no additional text labels.
- Bottom toolbar: fixed, simple icons without text labels; includes photo/video mode, central capture/record control, and effects-tray control.
- Effects tray: text labels only, uniform rectangular tiles, no thumbnails.
- Keep decoration, visual noise, and unnecessary copy to a minimum.

8. Product principles

- **Simplicity:** Make the interface easy to understand and unobtrusive.
- **Experimentation:** Make effects easy to try and adjust.
- **Consistency:** Reuse shared controls and predictable interaction patterns where practical.
- **Modularity:** Add effects without rebuilding the camera experience.
- **Flexibility:** Keep early technical and creative decisions open until prototyping provides evidence.
- **Creative ownership:** Build toward independently configurable and manageable effects.

9. Future development

- Additional effects: ASI Symbols, Binary, and X's and O's.
- An Effect Lab for testing effects and parameters.
- Live previews using camera input and sample footage.
- A system for adding, editing, ordering, and publishing effects.
- A dashboard for managing effect settings and published defaults.
- More advanced camera-aware visual effects.

10. Technical direction

- Keep each effect separate from the main camera interface.
- Store effect names, defaults, and configurable parameters separately from effect implementation.
- Make shared controls reusable.
- Build and test incrementally; prioritize a working Bitmap experience before expanding the library.
- Keep implementation framework and detailed architecture open until prototyping.

11. Initial release acceptance criteria

A user can open Magi in a desktop or mobile browser, grant camera access, upload a photo or video, apply Bitmap, adjust scale and intensity, reset settings, capture a photo or record a video, retake, and save the result to their device. Bitmap must work reliably with live and uploaded media.

12. Decisions intentionally left open

- Exact Bitmap scale and intensity ranges.
- Depth-estimation approach and the precise influence of depth on the image.
- Video export format, quality, and recording limits.
- Browser camera permissions and compatibility behavior.
- Responsive layout details.
- Effect Lab placement and access.
- Long-term effect-management architecture.

Status: Initial working specification. This document records current product decisions; it is not a final technical contract.